

IBM Consulting

Rebuilding the consulting model around supervised AI agents rather than billable hours · www.ibm.com/consulting

1911

IBM founded

\$21B

2025 revenue

\$12.5B

GenAI book of business

93%

Fortune 500 on IBM hybrid cloud

52,000

Jan 2026 agent investigations

01 Overview

IBM's services arm, at over \$21B of 2025 revenue. It is the clearest example in this set of a consultancy restructuring its own delivery model around AI agents: Consulting Advantage lets IBM consultants build and manage agent teams, and Enterprise... Offering: Strategy, technology and operations consulting, systems integration and managed services, closely coupled to IBM's own stack — watsonx, Red Hat OpenShift, automation and the Z mainframe platform.	Key facts HQ: Armonk, New York Ownership: Segment of International Business Machines Corporation (NYSE: IBM) Revenue: Over \$21B in 2025, up from approximately \$20.7B in 2024 — roughly a third of IBM's total revenue, alongside Software at about \$26B and Infrastructure at about \$14B Web: www.ibm.com/consulting · LinkedIn Key people: Mohamad Ali (Senior Vice President, IBM Consulting) · Arvind Krishna (Chairman, President & Chief Executive Officer, IBM) Digital twin: Client-specific builds · GenAI: Yes (watsonx, agent supervision)
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02 Use Cases & Reported Metrics

Sector	Deployment	Reported impact	Source
Consulting delivery model	Consulting Advantage, unveiled in 2024, lets IBM consultants build and manage teams of AI agents; Enterprise Advantage, released in January 2026, gives clients the same platform...	52,000 investigations completed in January 2026 alone using this model	Link
Generative AI commercial traction	IBM's generative AI book of business, measured inception to date as software transactional revenue plus new SaaS annual contract value plus consulting signings on specific...	Passed \$12.5B inception to date by Q4 2025, up from \$9.5B and \$5B at earlier milestones	Link
Enterprise incumbency	Consulting sold alongside IBM's installed base, with 93% of the Fortune 500 using IBM hybrid cloud products — the distribution advantage the consulting arm sells into.	Consulting revenue rose to over \$21B in 2025 from approximately \$20.7B in 2024, accelerating on demand for AI...	Link

03 Competitive Landscape

Other vendors in this market: Accenture · Aziro · Bain & Company · Booz Allen Hamilton · Boston Consulting Group · Capgemini · Cognizant · Deloitte Where it sits: Ali describes the new consulting model as a live dashboard where humans monitor digital workers and vice versa — which is a materially different proposition from selling consultant days, and worth understanding whoever a PortCo ends up using.

04 GIP & BlackRock Connections

GIP became a wholly-owned BlackRock subsidiary in October 2024 and now operates as BlackRock's dedicated infrastructure-investment arm. Stakes below are standard institutional/index-fund positions unless otherwise noted.

Entity	Possible connection
Global Infrastructure Partners	No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. The most likely entry point is an existing IBM technology footprint at a PortCo — mainframe, Red Hat or watsonx — with consulting following the estate rather than being selected independently.
BlackRock	No publicly disclosed operating relationship; standard index holdings of IBM only.

05 Sentiment

Customer: Consulting accelerated in 2025 on demand for help designing, deploying and governing AI at scale — governance being the part clients struggle with most and the part IBM has built explicit tooling for in watsonx.governance.	What supports the story • The only firm in this set that has rebuilt its own delivery model around supervised AI agents and put volume numbers against it • \$12.5B generative AI book of business inception to date, up from \$5B roughly a year earlier • 93% of the Fortune 500 use IBM hybrid cloud products — an installed base consulting sells into rather than competing for cold	What to pressure-test • Consulting revenue grew only about 1.5% in 2025 — from roughly \$20.7B to over \$21B — well behind Accenture's 7% • Tightly coupled to IBM's own stack, so advice arriving through this channel is not vendor-neutral • Consulting has been flat in some recent periods; the acceleration is recent and narrow
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Employee: Not disclosed separately from IBM. IBM has publicly rebalanced its workforce toward AI and hybrid cloud skills while reducing roles in legacy infrastructure support, across a total workforce of...

Sources: IBM Consulting public filings/website, company fact sheets, Wikipedia, PitchBook/Crunchbase/Datanyze/BuiltIn profiles, Glassdoor employer reviews, vendor case studies and press releases as of Sept. 2026. Figures marked "est." or "not disclosed" are third-party estimates or unavailable — not company-confirmed — validate in diligence. Part of the Physical AI / Industrial AI for Critical Infrastructure market landscape.